

Rails Meet the River

I can explain the railway's principal coal purpose, its link to Stockton's river port and the opening-day passenger evidence.

[Open the original interactive lesson](#)

Arrival · retrieve the previous move

Standard

Rebuild: coal area → Darlington → Stockton port.

Pupil-chosen arrival variant

Arrival rule: retrieve before adding new content. Personal or family disclosure is never required.

Starter · question before verdict

Enquiry

Why did the Stockton & Darlington Railway link coal areas to the River Tees when it opened in 1825?

Retrieval question: What was the main early job of the railway?

- A. Move coal from inland collieries to Stockton's port
- B. Take holiday trips to the coast
- C. Carry Eston ironstone found in 1850

I Do · model the disciplinary move

Model the decision and evidence, not just the answer.

STEP Start with purpose: easier movement of coal to a river port.

STEP Trace collieries → rail → Stockton port → ship.

STEP Opening-day passengers matter, but do not erase the freight purpose.

Route strip · choose the stops in order

Coal's journey in 1825. Choose the four stops in the right order. Then choose Extend to 1830 .

I Do · model the disciplinary move

- A. railway
- B. ship
- C. colliery
- D. Stockton wharves

Your route: —

- A. Extend to 1830
- B. Freight or passengers?
- C. ↺ Reset

I Do · model the disciplinary move

Start at the coal.

I Do · model the disciplinary move



Schematic map of the 1825 railway and 1830 extension

We Do · evidence hinge

Commit before reveal: Which is the safest claim?

- A. It linked inland coal to the Tees, and the opening steam train also carried passengers in wagons
- B. It was built only for passengers
- C. It began because Eston ironstone was found

I Do 2 · connect and qualify

Model connection, limitation and honest uncertainty.

STEP River and rail formed a network.

STEP The line extended to a new port at Middlesbrough in 1830.

STEP A new connection can shift trade and growth, but a route map alone cannot prove every effect.

ADAPTED PRIMARY-SOURCE CARD

HUM-B-W10-C01 · John Backhouse reports the opening train

Provenance source: HUM-B-W10-S01

I Do 2 · connect and qualify

Fourteen-year-old John Church Backhouse described the 27 September 1825 opening train to his sister. His sketch labelled Locomotion, wagons for visitors and a coach called Experiment. He reported a very large crowd, but his reported numbers are not treated as an exact count.

Can establish Establish what one young witness noticed and reported about the opening train.

Cannot establish Establish exact passenger totals, every wagon's contents or every observer's view.

I Do 2 · connect and qualify

Accessible route Numbered details: 1 — young witness; 2 — opening day; 3 — locomotive; 4 — visitor wagons; 5 — Experiment coach; 6 — reported estimate, not verified total.

ADAPTED SECONDARY-SOURCE CARD

HUM-B-W10-C02 · Why the route met the Tees

Provenance source: HUM-B-W10-S02

I Do 2 · connect and qualify

The railway linked County Durham collieries to Stockton's wharves so coal could continue by ship. Coal was its most important early traffic. Stockton's wharves later proved too limited for the volume, helping prompt an extension to a new port at Middlesbrough.

Can establish Supports the coal purpose and the reason for seeking a downstream port.

Cannot establish Does not make the 1830 extension part of the original 1825 route.

I Do 2 · connect and qualify

Accessible route Route strip: collieries → railway → Stockton wharves → ship; later branch → Middlesbrough port.

We Do 2 · interactive humanities lab

Interactive probe: response → evidence or representation → adult receives → next question or scaffold changes.

Cargo Route Builder

CONSTRUCTED TEACHING SOURCE — created for classroom practice. It is not an archival original.

Disciplinary focus: Network flow, purpose and chronology

Build the route, classify goods and people, then put the three events in date order.

We Do 2 · interactive humanities lab

- route Coal area
- route Darlington
- route Stockton port
- route Ship

GOODS

- coal

PEOPLE

- passengers in wagons and the Experiment coach

We Do 2 · interactive humanities lab

Event order

- A. event 1825 — railway opening
- B. event 1830 — Middlesbrough extension
- C. event 1850 — Eston ironstone find

Evidence classification

- A. GOODS coal
- B. PEOPLE passengers in wagons
- C. PEOPLE Experiment coach

We Do 2 · interactive humanities lab

Accessible route: Four-step labelled route: coalfield/colliery → Darlington → Stockton port/wharf → ship. Goods, people and dates are also supplied as text cards.

Independent · build defensible evidence

Independent humanities mission

Rail–river network showing the 1825 coal purpose, the opening-day passenger evidence, and the 1830 extension as a later change.

16 minutes. Supported, Standard and Stretch are movable routes, not pupil labels.

HUMANITIES STUDIO READY

Source / materials Teacher-prepared constructed lab cards plus the locally approved source cards named for this lesson.

Independent · build defensible evidence

Care / access Use the stated text, visual, pointing, sorting, speaking or exactly scribed route. No personal or family disclosure is required.

Evidence target Rail–river network showing the 1825 coal purpose, the opening-day passenger evidence, and the 1830 extension as a later change.

Supported

Build the four-node coal route.

Evidence: Route plus one because-link.

Coal moved from ____ by ____ to ____.

Independent · build defensible evidence

Fade the first prompt no longer needed.

Standard

Add cargo and a careful 1825 claim.

Evidence: Annotated network plus claim.

The railway mattered because it linked ____ to ____.

Stretch

Compare the 1825 purpose with the 1830 extension and add a limit.

Evidence: Chronological comparison plus limitation.

Independent · build defensible evidence

In 1825 _____. By 1830 _____. This evidence cannot prove _____.

Exit · receive, interpret, influence

Standard

Explain the railway–river link.

VOICE: The pupil explains the railway–river link through the selected exit route and chooses MYSTERY ROCK or ESTON MAP for Week 11.

One BUILD Humanities close only; no signature, receipt, upload queue or second closure form.